Nivolumab every 4 weeks for head and neck cancer

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00484 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Your practical treatment plan

Nivolumab is given as 480 mg through a vein over 60 minutes OR 1200 mg as an injection under the skin over 3–5 minutes, on Day 1 every 4 weeks. Your team selects one formulation; these doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram. Allow extra time for safety checks, preparation and observation. Treatment continues until the cancer progresses or side effects become unacceptable, with individual benefit and safety review. There is no fixed number of cycles in this head and neck treatment course.

STEP 1

Appointments

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STEP 2

Course length

Treatment continues until the cancer progresses or side effects become unacceptable, with individual benefit and safety review. There is no fixed number of cycles in this head and neck treatment course.

STEP 3

Tests and review

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests and glucose before every 4-week cycle. Thyroid tests before each cycle and when clinically indicated; cortisol when clinically indicated.

STEP 4

Home record

Carry your treatment record, actual urgent contacts and medicine list. Tell the team about line redness, swelling, leakage, pain or fever.

STEP 5

Follow-up

Keep reporting new symptoms after treatment ends. Immune side effects require monitoring for at least five months after the last dose. Steroid tapers, hormone replacement or specialist review may continue longer. Scans and examinations follow your individual response and follow-up plan.

Sources: NCCP 00484 v13a: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.